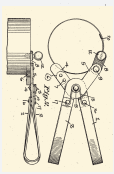
MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume XV Issue III Fall 2025



Living on the Faultline. Earthquakes that shook Mountain View
Page 7



Patent Holders of Mountain View. Prolific Creator disappears
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MVHA Providing more photos from our archives online
Page 6

# More than Orchards: Mountain View in Gilded Age America 1880-1920




This richly illustrated talk, Sunday, November 2, in the Community Room of the Mountain View Public Library, presents Mountain View as a mirror reflecting some of the larger transformations during a crucial period in the development of California and the nation. Placed in this context, the story of Mountain View's growth, especially its business and agricultural development, sheds important light on topics including technological innovation, railroads, immigration, political reform, and leisure. Mountain View contributed significantly to the growth of the state as well as the nation through its specialty crops, and to the empowerment of women through its clubs and suffrage campaigns.
*Nancy Unger's Profile, Page 3*

**Sunday, November 2, 2025 ▪ 2 p.m. ▪ The Community Room, Mountain View Public Library ▪ 585 Franklin Street, Mountain View, CA**

REGISTER ONLINE: **http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com**

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

*This newsletter is published four times a year by the*
**MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION**
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
**www.mountainviewhistorical.org**

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# News & Notes

## President's Message

**By Pamela Baird** ***MVHA President***



Pamela Baird

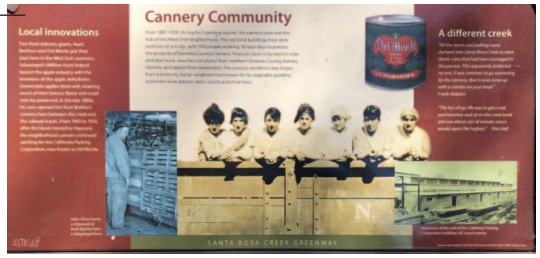
## *Marking History*

At the recent community meeting about planning for the Downtown Precise https://collaborate.mountainview.gov/downtown-precise-plan, I was pleased to hear participants express a desire to know more about the history of downtown Mountain View. Suggestions were made about creating historical markers, placing QR codes on buildings which would detail the history of a specific building or site and other suggestions, including the formation of a historical advisory committee.

As much as I wanted to jump up to remind everyone that the MVHA conducts monthly walking tours, I contained my enthusiasm and stayed seated. It was great to hear the comments about how the downtown area can be enhanced and improved.

A survey is available online if you want to provide input—https://www.surveymonkey.com/r/B6HJH72.

In my travels I am curious to learn how other communities detail and mark areas and buildings of significant importance. A variety of panel designs are used to illustrate history. The city of Santa Rosa displays a panel discussing the history of the canning industry next to the railroad tracks used to ship the completed products.




Mountain View could place something similar in several locations of former canning factories near the downtown railroad tracks.

The town of Barth, Germany, where my great grandparents lived, has a rich and long history dating to the 1500s. The town has several markers detailing the history, which include a map of the area




Markers can be created which include a QR code to provide more information than can be contained on a small panel. This is a great way to provide a comprehensive story of history.




MVHA is interested in developing more markers, either through a collaboration with the city or private entities.

We have so much history to share with the community and visitors. **Can you help us with this goal? If interested —please contact us at — info@mountainviewhistorical.org.**

**Upcoming Walking Tours of Downtown Mountain View**
**October 26 and November 23, 2025.**
**http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com/**

# Financial Report

as of September 30, 2025
Checking Account Balance: $15, 396.31
Certificates of Deposit: $64,194.77

# Treasurer Report-

The board is excited to announce that Anthea Chung has joined the board as treasurer. She brings over 20 years of experience in finance and accounting as a CPA. Learn more about her on the MVHA website. https://www.mountainviewhistorical.org/about-the-association/

# Membership Report

We welcome our new member David Camp. MVHA relies on membership dues to cover the cost of insurance, newsletter publication, history event costs and outreach efforts.

You can renew or become a member by returning the form (see page 9) with a check or going to the website: https://www.mountainviewhistorical.org/memberships/.

The MVHA is looking for someone to lead the membership efforts!
We need help with recruiting new members, maintaining the membership rosters and encouraging prompt renewals for existing members.
If interested— please send an email to info@mountainviewhistorical.org.

In our continuing series about Mountain View's Innovators, in this issue we have profiled George Pattberg (p. 4) and Isaac Stemm and John Glaze (p. 8) on their contributions to technology. See the complete Timeline on our website: **mountainviewhistorical.org**




# Community Outreach

## The board and volunteers have been busy attending community events.

Neighborhood socials held for the Old Mountain View, Monta Loma, Cuesta Park and Shoreline West areas provided a great avenue for MVHA to speak to people about the history of their neighborhoods and MV.

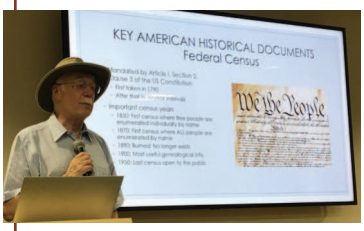


Robert Cox and Melanie Kaye created trifold flyers about the history of the Wagon Wheel, Monta Loma and Old Mountain View neighborhoods, which were distributed at those events. MVHA is planning to create additional flyers for other Mountain View neighborhoods in 2026




**Carol Donahue, Pamela Baird, Anthea Chung and Elena Lopez offer visitors information and history books at Bubb Park**

MVHA participated in the Fall Harvest Festival at Heritage Park on September 13 and the Volunteer Fair on August 30. Both events gave us the opportunity to speak about the events and programs that MVHA creates.




Additionally, Robert Cox presented two lectures, one in July and one in August, about conducting genealogy research. These were held at the MV Library. Watch for information about future lectures at the MV Library presented by the MVHA.

**Expanded Hours at the History Center**
**Now open Thursdays 4:00pm-8:00pm**
**In addition to Tuesdays**
**1:00pm – 4:00 pm**
**Visit our ever expanding archives, including Mountain View High School Yearbooks**

FALL WINTER

## Disasters in Mountain View

The topic of "Disasters in Mountain View" attracted a group interested in learning about earthquakes, fires and airplane crashes. All three presenters, IdaRose Sylvester, Pamela Baird and David Salinero, quickly learned in doing their research that each could easily have given a 45 minute individual program.

The presentation prepared by IdaRose was delivered in a recorded format (because of her travel plans she could not attend in person). We hope to include this on the MVHA website so that more can view it. She concentrated on the stories of the1906 and 1989 earthquake and included information about additional local fault lines, which we hope will not be activated in the future.

In the presentation about fires Pamela focused on four categories of fires-commercial & business, multi-family, deaths and heroes. The group was surprised to learn about the large number of multi-family fires and deaths. A common cause of death in fires used to be caused by smoking cigarettes, but fortunately that caused has been greatly reduced because fewer people smoke. But the rise in the use of lithium batteries has created a new fire hazard.

Lastly, David concentrated his presentation on the tragic crash of February 1, 1957, and its effects on Mountain View history. This crash took the life of the pilot, Capt. Robert Mulvehill Jr., a husband and father of four young children. Debris from the plane damaged many downtown homes. The incident made a permanent impact on the quality of life in Mountain View, as more people petitioned the Navy to halt high speed jet flights over the city.

After the presentations, ice cream was enjoyed by all- our annual ritual of indulging in frozen delights.

TECHNOLOGY

# George Pattberg *Prolific Creator*


MOUNTAIN VIEW
Automobile and Machine Works
GEO. A. PATTBERG, Prop.
Designer and consulting expert in all classes of machinery. Orders for repairs promptly executed.
OFFICE AND FACTORY
Corner of View and Dana Streets.

**Pattberg's ad from the 1904 High School yearbook.**

Perhaps one of the most intriguing of the men we profiled for the early patent holders series is George Pattberg. He was born in Germany in 1860 and immigrated to Utah in 1883. He married Elizabeth Hoffman, also an immigrant from Germany. Their daughter was born in 1890 in Utah. Even though he was not living in Mountain View when his patents were granted, we are claiming him as our own because of the interesting story of his life.

By the mid-1890s he is living in Oakland, where Pattberg listed his occupation in several directories as that of a machinist working for the Southern Pacific Railroad. The 1900 census showed him living in Fremont township (rural MV) with his wife, daughter and mother-in-law.

Pattberg quickly established a machine shop—the Mountain View Automobile and Machine Works— in 1901 in a newly built facility located on the corner of View and Dana streets.

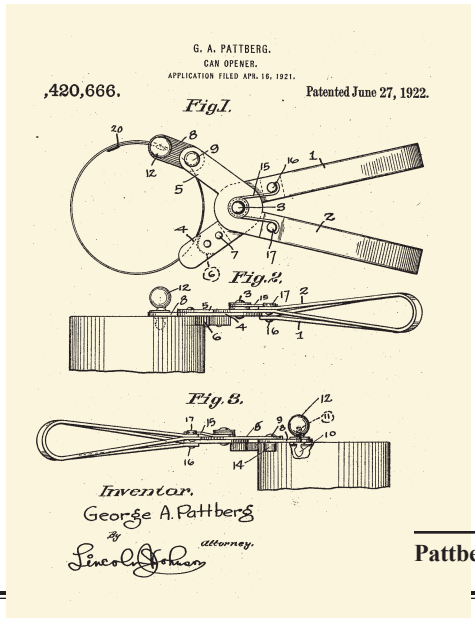
The Register-Leader newspaper noted in 1903 that George Pattberg "makes a specialty of building and repairing automobiles."

The early 1900s was a crazy and exciting time for the beginning of the automobile industry. Evidently machine shops all around the US were manufacturing their own versions of an automobile.

The conditions were similar those of the early dot.com boom at the beginning of this century. Many individuals and companies were trying to figure out how to become established automobile designers, suppliers, repair shops and manufacturers.

In 1902 the city of Mountain View was incorporated, with Pattberg being a strong proponent for the incorporation. Serving as the first trustees (or council members as they are called today) were George Pattberg and his friend Dr. O. C. Gates and three other prominent citizens.

George Pattberg was one of those men working to assemble automobiles in his shop. The Register-Leader newspaper noted at the end of 1903 Pattberg "is building a fine auto car for Dr. Gates." Apparently, he had been working on it for almost a year. "Sometimes it ran and sometimes it did not" according to the newspaper.


G. A. PATTBERG.
CAN OPENER.
APPLICATION FILED APR. 16, 1921.
1,420,666. Patented June 27, 1922.
Fig.1.
Fig.2.
Fig.3.
Inventor.
George A. Pattberg
By Lincoln Johnson attorney.

**Pattberg's patented can opener.**

As a point of reference, Henry Ford introduced the Model A in 1903. About 1700 automobiles were produced that year by the Ford Motor Company. The Oldsmobile company produced over 3,000 cars in 1903.

According to a 1927 article in the Register Leader that covered the early history of the town, sometime in early 1904 —

"The night before an announced public demonstration [of the new auto], Pattberg's house, workshop and car took fire mysteriously and burned to the ground. Pattberg left here soon after and never returned".

One can imagine that this event must have devastated George Pattberg and Dr. Gates as well. This makes one wonder— *Why did the newspaper describe the fire as "mysterious"? Why did Pattberg leave? Did he face scorn from his fellow residents?*

By 1920 the family was living on a farm in Concord, CA. It is after this point that he applied for and received four patents. The first in January 1922 was for a rack to hold brooms and mops. The second was for a rodent trap that shoots a projectile at the offending critter.

The third was for the can opener. The patent application states *"The principal object of this invention is to provide an improved can opener. A further object consists in providing a can opener that will be simple and inexpensive to construct."* The final patent was for a variable speed transmission.

We don't know if he was able to sell his patents or create any actual products. Mr. Pattberg passed away in 1926 at the age of 66 years leaving a wife and daughter.

# Finding Your Family History

***by Robert Cox,***
***MVHA Vice President***

## Managing Your Genealogy Research Budget

One of the best pieces of advice I ever received regarding genealogy was, "Before you get started on research, estimate how much you are willing to spend on it. There is no end to opportunities to buy access to more information."

**"Before you get started on research, estimate how much you are willing to spend on it."**

Of course, the simplest way of managing your genealogy research budget is to only use information that you can essentially get for free. This includes doing online searches, visiting the local library or history center, using the Mormon church sponsored Family Search website, and using Ancestry from your local library. You can accomplish a lot by doing just this. But whatever research you do will leave some questions unanswered, and that's when you'll need to decide whether to take the plunge and pay for access to tools that can provide additional information.

The companies selling these tools understand that many people will be reluctant to pay for additional information, so they offer deep discounts to get you started ordering from them. Ancestry offers a free 14 -day trial subscription, but you need to select a paid subscription plan and cancel after 14 days if you don't want to be charged. They also have offered gift memberships around the holidays at 50% off. Note, though, that the regular subscription price ranges from $264/year to $840/year, depending on the records to which you want access. One way to control the cost of your subscriptions is to try various options (like access to newspapers) for a while and then drop them after you can no longer get a discounted price. A more drastic move is to cancel your subscription
and renew it again later at the introductory price.

Making continuing payments is also an issue if you use a tool like Family Tree Maker to manage your family tree on your local computer. I had paid $80 for the software package.

I resisted paying for upgrades because I didn't see the company adding any new useful features. But one day I tried to upload a family tree I had done to Ancestry, and the feature didn't work. The person on the company help line told me that the version I had bought was no longer supported, so I would need to buy the latest version. So, in reality, there was no such thing as "pay once and you're done.".

# Mountain View Family History Spotlight

**By Robert Cox**

Former Mayor Nick Galiotto's family history is peppered with stories of how a spirit of adventure, combined with resilience, and a willingness to work hard leads to success.

Nick's paternal grandfather, also called Nicolo Galiotto, was born in Contessa Entellina, a small town near Palermo, Sicily. After immigrating to America through the Port of New Orleans in 1894, Grandfather Nicolo and family relocated to San Francisco. Following the 1906 San Francisco earthquake, Grandfather Nicolo decided it would be best to move to San Jose.

Grandfather Nicolo and his wife Santa (Cynthia) raised nine children, of which future Mayor Nick's father, Salvador, was the youngest. Both parents and all of the children worked on the family orchard.



**Victor Andrew Galiotto, Boxer and famous Boxing Promoter**

One of Salvador's older brothers, Victor Andrew Galiotto, was a prizefighter, then a legendary boxing promoter "Babe Griffin." He was inducted into the Boxing Hall of Fame in 1990.

Salvador Galiotto and his wife Carmelle raised three children, of which future Mayor Nick was the youngest. Nick was always dedicated to self-improvement through education. He studied philosophy and communications in college with the intention of becoming an attorney but then decided to enter the police force, as he believed he could make a greater impact in contributing to the community. Starting as a patrolman in Mountain View, he took both the sergeant's and lieutenant's exams. He finished first on both.

Nick's future wife, Rebecca Moore, came from Kansas to San Jose as a young girl. She had a reputation of being a rifle sharpshooter, carrying a rifle with her on the bus to target practice. Rebecca met Nick in college. She played a game of chess with Nick and beat him! Rebecca majored in chemistry in college, went to work at Lockheed- Ames Research, and was always on the forefront of women's employment opportunities.

Once Nick was on the police force, Nick and Rebecca decided to live in Mountain View, as this was expected of police officers at that time. Nick was one the first local officers hired during the progressive wave in police work. Police officers were now expected to be college-educated and engage with the community when establishing policing practices. Nick served 26 years on the Mountain View police force.

Nick joined the Mountain View City Council after winning a special election to replace Mayor Mario Ambra.

*– continued on page 8*


Robin Faxon

Imagine being a live model in a store front window of a building at 278 Castro Street- trying to hold that perfect pose for ten minutes without moving! Doing this is a fond memory of Robin Faxon, a former member of the Palo Alto Assembly of Rainbow Girls.

The building, which was owned by Marjorie Minton and her sister Grace Brunhofer, was the location of the JC Penney department store. The store closed in 1966 when JC Penney relocated to the Mayfield Mall.

At the time, Rainbow Girls was a service organization for girls and young women, aged 11 to 20 years. Their fathers were members of the local Masonic Lodge, or their mothers were members of Eastern Star.

The organization taught leadership training through community service. Mrs. Minton and Mrs. Brunhofer offered the use of the building for the Rainbow Girls to hold a rummage sale. Proceeds from the sale were used to donate money to a local charity. In addition to the five young ladies acting as models, furniture, toys and household items were sold in the fundraiser.


Robin as a young lady

The photo below shows the 200 block of Castro Street on an early evening in 1953. Just beyond the Knight's Drug Store sign on the left was the J. C. Penney department store, which occupied this location for over 25 years.






The building was eventually acquired by Meyer Appliance in 1972. In 2012, they relocated to El Camino Real. Since then, the building has been the home of several hi-tech startups, including the current tenant, GMI Cloud. This company helps its customers architect, deploy, optimize and scale their Artificial Intelligence strategies.

Robin later married James Yurash. The couple moved to the North Whisman Mountain View neighborhood in 1996. They are still living there today!

# More MVHA Photos Online

**David Salinero, Historical Data Chair**

MVHA is now a contributing partner to **California Revealed**, a statewide program to digitize and provide online access to thousands of objects from museums, libraries, and historical societies. Items contributed to California Revealed are also available on the Internet Archive. We are on a long-term mission to provide better accessibility to the MVHA collection, and contributing to California Revealed is part of that strategy.

Our first contribution consists of 77 photos and postcards depicting:

- The Pacific Press Buildings circa 1948.
- The 1949 Centennial Festival— which shows men dressed in 1849 western wear, a children's parade, and parade floats traveling down California Street.
- The 1950 Harvest Festival— of parade floats traveling along Castro Street.




These new MVHA items are now online via:

**California Revealed** — https://californiarevealed.orgchallenge?destination=/partner/mountainviewhistoricalassociation

**Internet Archive** — https://archive.org/details/mountain-view-historical-association

Other MVHA items are available on the Mountain View Public Library website— https://californiarevealed.org/partner/mountain-view-public-library

We will continue to pursue ways to make more items available online. If you have an interest in helping, contact the MVHA to volunteer.

# Earthquakes and Mountain View's History

*By* **IdaRose Sylvester**
Mountain View Historical Association Boardmember

Earthquakes are an unavoidable part of life in California. For those of us who grew up here, the ground shaking is not just an occasional scare—it's a reminder of the deep geological forces that shape our region and our community. Having lived through the 1989 Loma Prieta earthquake, I became especially interested in how Mountain View has experienced and responded to major quakes, and what we can learn from the past to prepare for the future.

**Why Earthquakes Matter Here**

The Bay Area is crisscrossed by fault lines, from the massive San Andreas to smaller but still significant systems like the Hayward Fault. Scientists estimate the likelihood of a magnitude 6.7 or greater quake in the next 20 years at troublingly high levels for many of these faults. To make things more personal for Mountain View residents, the Monte Vista–Shannon fault—a short but powerful segment capable of producing a magnitude 7.1 quake—runs directly beneath nearby Foothill College. Its discovery is a stark reminder that even faults we don't yet know about can pose major risks.

**Mountain View's Earthquake History**

While countless tremors have been felt over the decades, two major earthquakes define Mountain View's historical record: the 1906 San Francisco earthquake and the 1989 Loma Prieta earthquake. Both quakes struck the San Andreas fault, but their impacts on Mountain View differed dramatically.

The 1906 earthquake, estimated at magnitude 7.8, was roughly sixteen times stronger and four times longer than Loma Prieta. Though its epicenter was farther away, Mountain View saw significant structural damage. By contrast, the 6.9-magnitude Loma Prieta quake struck closer, but caused comparatively less visible destruction within our city limits—even if the overall financial toll was higher because of damage to modern infrastructure such as highways and hospitals.

**1906: A Town Shaken to Its Core**

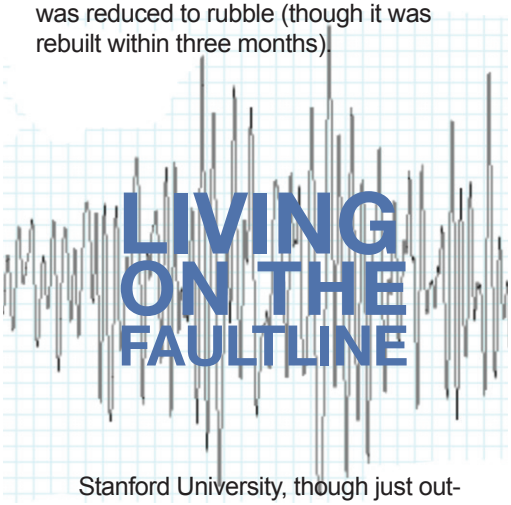
At the time of the 1906 quake, Mountain View was a small town of just 800 residents. Yet the local press captured the disaster in detail. Reports estimated about $5.4 million in today's dollars of damage within city limits.





**The Olympic Hall** (left) **was reduced to rubble in the 1906 earthquake,and the Ames Building** (below) **was rebuilt.**

Iconic buildings such as Olympic Hall and the Ames Building were severely damaged, although the Ames Building was repairable and still stands today. Rogers & Rogers, the city's largest dry goods store, collapsed while seven people were sleeping inside—miraculously, all survived. Municipal water towers toppled, the Pacific Press publishing campus was leveled, and the Fruit Exchange was reduced to rubble (though it was rebuilt within three months).




Stanford University, though just outside Mountain View, also suffered heavily. Memorial Church lost its steeple, sandstone buildings collapsed, and millions of dollars of damage was recorded—remnants of which can still be seen today.



**Stanford University Campus after the 1906 Quake**

**1989: A Modern Test**

In 1989, Mountain View's population and infrastructure had grown dramatically. Loma Prieta caused about $30 million in direct local damage, in today's dollars. Nearly 100 buildings were reported damaged, with likely many more unreported. El Camino Hospital sustained serious harm that eventually led to a complete rebuild at a cost of half a billion dollars.

The Adobe Building had significant structural damage and was almost lost, due to enormous repair costs. It was saved by a determined community fundraising effort. Fire stations, overpasses, commercial buildings, and mobile homes all suffered varying degrees of damage. Modern infrastructure, which didn't exist in 1906, faced the greatest damage and caused most of the financial loss.

Stanford again endured major losses. The university's rebuilding costs were estimated at $300 million in today's dollars. Neighboring communities such as Los Altos Hills also faced cracked roads, broken water mains, and homes shaken from their foundations.

**Recording and Remembering**

One striking difference between the two earthquakes is the historical record itself. In 1906, Mountain View had a strong local newspaper that carefully documented damage and community response.

By 1989, no Mountain View paper existed, so coverage was limited. Regional papers focused on the much more visible and tragic damage in Santa Cruz, Watsonville, San Francisco, and Oakland. Much of our understanding comes from neighboring publications, scattered archives, and—more recently—personal recollections shared online.

First-person memories posted decades later on Facebook, for instance, bring the quake vividly back to life: a nurse recalling ICU chaos at El Camino Hospital, residents watching transformers explode across town (while managing to hold on to their beer!), and high school students knocked off their feet during marching band practice.

These stories remind us that history is not only about buildings and numbers but also about human experiences—and how easily they can be lost without intentional preservation.

– continued from page 5



**Mayor Nick with his parents Salvador and Carmen Galiotto**

Previously, he had served on the Planning Commission and was the campaign manager for councilmember Robert K. Schatz. Nick was most proud that, while he was on council, eight public projects were completed, including many city parks. After he was on council, Nick became a general practice attorney, served on the Santa Clara Grand Jury as Foreperson, and continued as an active participant in the community as President of both the Mountain View Historical Association and our local Kiwanis chapter.

Nick passed away three years ago. Nick and Rebecca had two sons, David and Jerry. David relocated to Seattle, Washington, where he worked in corporate finance, but then passed away. David and his wife Jill had three children: Shannon, Ally, and Brady. Jerry stayed local and was, until his recent retirement, the National Manager of the Special Investigations Unit for CSAA.

Rebecca's advice to young people is—*"Keep your nose to the grindstone! There will be time for fun later!"*



**The Nick and Rebecca Galiotto Family**

TECHNOLOGY

# Isaac F. Stemm & John H. Glaze Answering A Need

**by Pamela Baird**

**"The general object of the present invention is to provide a roller harrow particularly designed for use in orchards and other like places where cultivation must be deep and where the machine must run close up to the trees."**

From the early 1900s to the 1950s thousands of acres of land in Mountain View, Sunnyvale and Los Altos were planted with plum, apricot and cherry trees producing high quality products. In 1920 40% of the prune crop was exported to Europe. This created the need for machinery to serve the orchard industry.

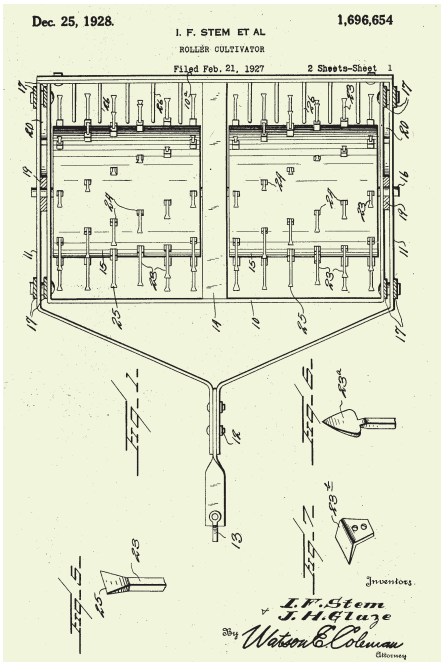
Isaac F. Stemm was a native of Tennessee. In 1892 at the age of 25 he married Effie Moon. They had a son and daughter. The 1900 census showed his occupation as a farmer in Tennessee. Ten years later the census listed him as a tenant farmer in San Jose. He only had a fifth grade education.



**Neighbors and Collaborators**

★ **John H Glaze home** ★ **Isaac F. Stemm home**
★ **Lua Glaze, then Isaac Stemm and wife's home**

In 1930 he and Effie were living at 412 Central Ave. His occupation is that of farmer. This area of MV contained small fruit orchards. Being an "orchardist" probably gave him the insight to see the need to create a better roller tiller.




We don't know how he and John Glaze became collaborators and evidently friends as well.

Cultivation is the practice of working the soil to increase aeration and water flow, and to destroy weeds and/or crop residue. A cultivator is a mechanical implement for breaking up the ground and uprooting weeds. The patent for a roller cultivator was granted on December 25, 1928. Isaac was 61 years of age and John was 67.

The patent description further describes their device as well suited for cutting up cover crops, which are planted to manage soil erosion, weeds and pests and increase soil fertility and soil quality.

By 1940 he and Effie were living on Villa Street. Houses in this area were later demolished in the construction of the Shoreline overpass above the train tracks and the Bailey/Shoreline widening project. Isaac passed away in 1948.

John H. Glaze was born in Indiana in 1861. At the age of 21 he married Ruth Marvin. She died only three years later, leaving him with two young boys, Carl and Mark. Seven years later he married Lua Hinshaw. They had two children, Fred and Eileen.

The 1900 census showed them living in Kansas with Glaze's occupation listed as a harness maker. Ten years later, while still in Kansas, his occupation is shown as a porter. In 1920 the family was living in Nebraska, and his occupation is now that of an electrician.

By the early 1920s Glaze and his family have relocated to Mountain View where his son Carl owned a plumbing business located at 220 Castro Street. Evidently Glaze worked with or for his son.

An article in the MV Register Leader of September 30, 1927, states that a shop & garage belonging to his son Carl, located at 1250 Mercy Street, was destroyed by fire. Two automobiles, a truck and the contents are lost, but not the home at the front of the property. It can't be determined if the business had relocated there from the Castro Street location.

The 1930 census showed Glaze and his wife living in a house that they owned at 484 Bailey Road, which is now Shoreline Boulevard. His occupation is that of a plumber. He passed away in 1936.

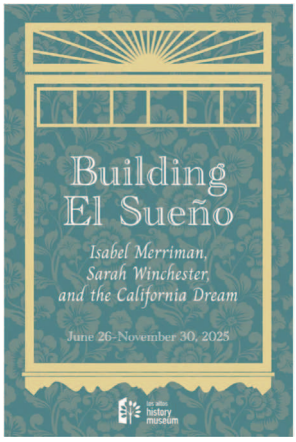
It's unknown if the two were able to license the patent or create a company to produce their invention.

## MVHA Recommends:

Main Gallery los altos history museum

Interested in local history? Isable Merriman has ties to Mountain View. Don't miss this exhibit chronicling the little known story of Sarah Winchester's sister.

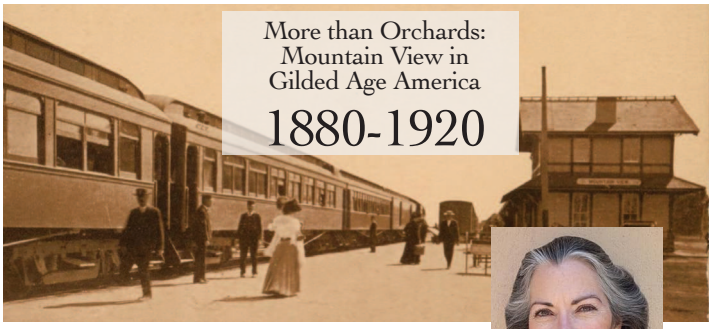
**Isabel Merriman, Sarah Winchester, and the California Dream Ends Nov 30, 2025**



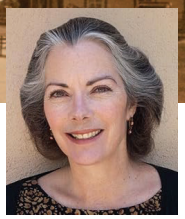

Who was Isabel Merriman? Long overshadowed by the myths and mysteries surrounding her sister Sarah Winchester, Isabel's life and work have long gone unrecognized. This exhibition offers a window into the untold story of an energetic whirlwind of a woman who championed the rights of children and animals, refused to compromise her sense of justice, and left a lasting impression on everyone she met.

**https://www.losaltoshistory.org/exhibit/elsueno/**

## ON THE COVER




## ABOUT THE SPEAKER



**Nancy C. Unger** is Professor Emeritus of History at Santa Clara University. She has served as President of the Society for Historians of the Gilded Age and Progressive Era, and three of her four books focus on that historical period. Her op-eds applying the lessons of the past to the present have appeared in dozens of publications and websites, including The Washington Post, CNN, and TIME. Her talk "Everyday Americans in the Gilded Age," sponsored by the Newport Mansion Society, was presented in The Breakers, the Vanderbilt mansion. Additional appearances include Public Radio International, National Public Radio, PBS American Experience, and the BBC, and she is featured in five hour-long programs on C-SPAN.

**Sunday, November 2, 2025 ▪ 2 p.m.**
**The Community Room, Mountain View Public Library**
**585 Franklin Street, Mountain View, CA**

## MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! You can also join/renew online at **www.mountainviewhistorical.org**. Membership is tax deductible to the extent permitted by law. The MVHA is a tax-exempt organization under Internal Revenue Code Section 501(c)(3), Tax ID 94-6115407.

☐ New Membership

☐ Membership Renewal

☐ Household Annual Membership *$30/year*

☐ Individual Lifetime Membership *$300*

☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

Name(s)_____

City _____

State_____ Zip Code _____

Phone_____

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☐ *I'd like a print-edition subscription of the newsletter.(To save paper and costs, the default subscription is a digital emailed newsletter.)*

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Mountain View, CA 94042

*Thank you!*

FALL WINTER

## CALENDAR

**October 26**
Downtown Walking tour
http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com/
**October 27**
Board meeting on zoom
**November 2**
Quarterly History Event – MV Library 2 pm
"More than Orchards: Mountain View in Gilded Age America 1880-1920"
http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com/
**November 23**
Downtown Walking tour
http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com/
**December 1**
Board meeting on zoom
**February 1, 2026**
Quarterly History Event
more information to come

**The MVHA is looking for someone to lead the membership efforts! We need help with recruiting new members, maintaining the membership rosters & encouraging prompt renewals for existing members. If interested- please send an email to info@mountainviewhistorical.org.**

## LOOKING BACK: IMAGES FROM THE ARCHIVES

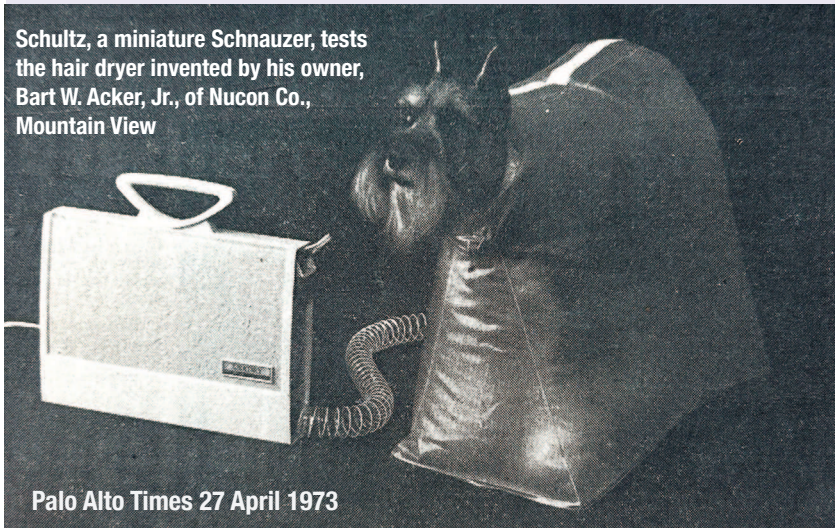
### Latest in dog grooming

**Mountain View Firm making dryer for pets**

If electric hair dryers are popular for people, why not dogs? That was the reasoning of Bart W. Acker, Jr., a Saratoga man who has formed a Mountain View company around the idea. His pet dryer, called Anadry, works on much the same principle as hair dryers for humans.

A motor-heater unit blows in air through a flexible plastic hose to the container, into which the dog is zippered. Ten minutes does the job, Acker reports.

Acker's firm, Nucon (for new concepts) has another product. It's an industrial timer invented by John Crane of Mountain View, Acker's partner. Nucon is distributing the per dryer through distributors in the U.S. and is field testing units in Europe.



Schultz, a miniature Schnauzer, tests the hair dryer invented by his owner, Bart W. Acker, Jr., of Nucon Co., Mountain View

Palo Alto Times 27 April 1973

EST. 1954
MOUNTAIN REVIEW
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
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Mountain View, CA 94042
WEB: www.mountainviewhistorical.org
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